

BRASS & BONE CHRONICLES

CREATED BY
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ヴォーン

CHAPTER

07

SHATTER THE SNARE
捕縛を断て



ANCHORITE
VANGUARD

TENSION & TRUST

RENN LEVIN · TENSION-GAUNTLET

張力と信頼

SLOANE VIREN · ANCHORITE POLEARM

TWO HEARTS. ONE SNARE. NO ROOM FOR FEAR.

CALIPER RUINS

OUTER SPAN / FORGOTTEN SECTOR

A TITANIC REMNANT,
CAST HORIZONTAL
LIKE A TUNING FORK
AGAINST THE SKY.

OLDER THAN MAPS.
OLDER THAN MEMORY.

EPISODE 07

SWING-CLIPPER

< TOWARD THE CALIPER >

SOME PLACES
DON'T WANT
TO BE FOUND.

GLIDE LOW.
STAY QUIET.
DON'T WAKE
THE PAST.

VSSSHH

BIOLUMINESCENT
VINES.
PULSE: SLOW.
PATTERN: UNKNOWN.

BEAUTIFUL.
UNNERVING.

THRRMMM

THAT THING...
HOW DOES
SOMETHING
THAT BIG
EVEN STAY
UP?

GRAVITY
ANCHORS.
OLD WORLD
MATH.
OR OLDER.

SENSOR READINGS
ARE ALL OVER
THE PLACE.

IT'S LIKE THE RUIN
DOESN'T BELONG
TO THIS GRID.

CALIPER RUINS

OR MAYBE...
WE DON'T.

EITHER WAY,
WE FIND OUT
WHAT'S INSIDE.

BIX DOUBLE-CHECKS
THE ANCHOR.
AGAIN.

KNOT ANGLE: 43°...
TENSION: STABLE...
SLIP RISK: MINIMAL...
...MINIMAL...

...MINIMAL...

CHK-
CHK...
CHK...

RENN DOESN'T
THINK.
HE JUST GOES.

TENSION-GAUNTLET:
SPOOL ENGAGED.

GRAVITY?
OVERRATED.

SLOANE STUDIES
THE IMPOSSIBLE
HORIZON.

TREES THAT GROW
SIDWAYS.
ROOTS THAT DEFY
REASON.

DISQUIETING.

...AND YET,
WE ADAPT.

ALL LINES
SECURE.
DESCENT
SEQUENCE
INITIATED.

OPERATION: HORIZONTAL DESCENT
OBJECTIVE: ROOT-SEED EXTRACTION
STATUS: IN PROGRESS



THRESHOLD OF ECHOES.
HOUR OF DUSK.

ANOTHER DAY,
ANOTHER HORIZON
THAT DOESN'T
CARE WE EXIST.

STILL... FIRE.
WARMTH.
RHYTHM.

THAT'S ENOUGH
TO HOLD THE
DARK BACK.

BIX, YOU'VE
BEEN STARING AT
THAT THING FOR
AN HOUR.

I KNOW.
I JUST-

EVERY TICK
FEELS LOUDER
OUT HERE.

LIKE IT'S
COUNTING DOWN
TO SOMETHING.
OR WARNING ME
I'M ALREADY LATE.

I JUST HOPE
IT'S NOT RIGHT.

CODA DOESN'T
SEEM TO MIND.
FIRE, FULL
TUMMY, SAFE
PLACE...

LUCKY.

SECTOR 7-19
OUTER RIM SALVAGE BELT

NO MAN'S LAND.
NO LAW.
JUST DEBT.

HORIZON
RECOVERY & ASSET RETRIEVAL

KRRRMMM

EVENING.

I HOPE I'M
NOT INTERRUPTING
SOMETHING
IMPORTANT.

THIS IS
PRIVATE CLAIM.
WE DON'T OWE
YOU ANYTHING.

OH, I'M
WELL AWARE.

THAT'S WHY
I'M HERE.
TO COLLECT.

HORIZON RECOVERY
HOLDS A LIEN ON ALL
UNREGISTERED ASSETS
AND IMPROVEMENTS
WITHIN THIS SECTOR.

PAYMENT IS DUE.
BY SUNSET.
IN FULL.

...

I FIND THAT
MOST PEOPLE
PREFER TO AVOID
...COMPLICATIONS.

DON'T MAKE ME
COME BACK.



SLOANE'S HEART IS CALM. HER HAND MOVES CALMLY.

MEASURED.

INEVITABLE.

WHOA, WHOA—
LET'S NOT DO
ANYTHING WE'LL
REGRET, YEAH?

WE'RE JUST
PASSING THROUGH.

LOOKING FOR
HIGH PLACES.

BIG VIEWS.

NO TROUBLE.



HIGH PLACES?
THIS IS
OUR CLIMB.



RIGHT—
RIGHT!
TOTALLY.

WE JUST THOUGHT
WE'D ASK NICE.
SAVE EVERYONE
A BUNCH OF—



CONTROL.
FOCUS.
BREATHE.



THE POLEARM
IS WHERE SHE
LEFT IT.

EXACTLY.
AS IT SHOULD
BE.



THREE AGAINST
TWO.

NUU.

THREE AGAINST
TWO AND A
MISTAKE.

RENN THINKS
FASTER THAN
HE SPEAKS.

GOOD.
HE'LL NEED
TO.



SO—
WHAT DO
YOU SAY?

WE POINT
YOU TO SOME
OTHER CLIMB?

SOMETHING
BIGGER.
BETTER.
LESS...
US?

KEEP THEM
TALKING.
KEEP THEM
GUSSING.
KEEP SLOANE
BREATHING.



ONE MOVE.
THAT'S ALL.

TENSION

CHAPTER 07: COUNTERWEIGHT

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THEY COUNTED
ON STRENGTH.

THEY FORGOT
SPEED.

RENN

TENSION-GAUNTLET
IMPROVISED. RISKY.
EFFECTIVE.

YANK!!

WHAT
THE—?!

GRAVITY'S
A TEAMMATE,
NOT A FOE.

SLOANE

ANCHORITE VANGUARD
DISCIPLINE. PRECISION.
LETHAL IN MOTION.

YOUR
BALANCE
IS POOR.

URK—!

CLICK!

SKREECH!

TWO WEAPONS.
TWO WILLS.
ONE ADVANTAGE.

SPEED.

THE OVERSEER'S
SKIFF. DEFEATED.



ENGINES
POWERING UP.
RETREATING.



Y-YEAH...
WE DID IT...



BIX. NERVOUS.
ANXIOUS. BUT
INTELLECTUALLY
FEARLESS.



PHYSICALLY
TIMID. BUT
ESSENTIAL.

THE SKIFF
PIVOTS UPWARD
AND AWAY.



W-WE
DID IT...!



A WEAK CHEER.
A VICTORY
EARNED.

CHAPTER 198: INTO THE CALIIPER
CALIPER RUINS
— DAWN —

The mouth of the Caliper Ruins yawns like the jaw of some long-dead leviathan.

Legends say a god once measured the world with these jaws.

THIS PLACE...
IT'S HUGE.

NO, IT'S
NOT UP...

Corroded gears.
Ancient pistons.
All swallowed by
something that
isn't quite alive.

...THIS IS
SIDWAYS.

THEN...
WHERE IS
"DOWN"?

EVERYTHING
...IS TILTED.

THE FLOOR
IS A WALL.

AND THE WALLS...
THEY GO ON
FOREVER.

THE CALIPER...
MEASURES
DISTANCE.

BUT MAYBE
IT WAS NEVER
MEANT FOR
HUMANS.

ITS PURPOSE
WAS TO
GAUGE THE
STARS.

NOT OUR
FOOTSTEPS.

THEN WE'LL
JUST HAVE TO
BE STARS THAT
WALK.

YEAH.

LET'S
MOVE.



GRAVITY'S
JUST A SUGGESTION.

SEE YOU
ON THE OTHER
SIDE!

THE DEEP LATTICE
- LEVEL 47 -
THE MYCOFORGE
PASSAGE

FOCUS.
FOOTING.
BREATHE.

K-CHAK
WHIRRRR

TENSION-GAUNTLET
MODEL: TG-07 "SPINEL"
MAX LOAD: 400KG
CURRENT TENSION: 320KG

RISK
IS A
VARIABLE.

DISCIPLINE
IS A
CHOICE.

NUMBERS...
STABILITY...
JUST DON'T
THINK ABOUT
THE DROP...

ONE SLIP
AND IT'S
ALL OVER.



THIS IS—
IT'S ACTUALLY
REAL.



THE ANCHOR.
MAGNITUDE
BEYOND ANY
CALCULATION.
EXQUISITE.



THE WEFT IS
CONVERGING—
NO, RESPONDING.
IT KNOWS
WE'RE HERE.
OH. OH NO.



SOMETHING OLD.
SOMETHING PATIENT.
SOMETHING WAITING.
FOR WHAT?

THE INNER CHAMBER.
ANCHOR MECHANISM.
STATUS: DORMANT...
OR SOMETHING
OLDER.

THE WEFT
GATHERS.
THERE IS STILL
A PULSE.

WHATEVER
IT IS—
IT HAS BEEN HERE
LONGER THAN TIME
REMEMBERS.

GNRRRRRRRR...

SOMETHING
DOWN HERE IS
NOT DORMANT
ANY LONGER...

THE PATTERN...
IT'S ALMOST
BIOLOGICAL...

$$\vec{a} \neq \frac{d\sigma}{dt}$$

$$\nabla \cdot \vec{E} = \rho$$

$$f_r = \frac{1}{2\pi} \frac{F_v}{T_r}$$

CALCULATING
RESONANT
FREQUENCIES...

$$\sigma = \frac{1}{\epsilon_0} \frac{dQ}{dt}$$

$$E = mc^2$$

TENSION-LINES
SPIKING... OFF
THE CHARTS!

THIS ISN'T
NATURAL...

RESONANCE
BUILDING
EXPONENTIALLY!



WE'RE INSIDE
A HARMONIC
FEEDBACK LOOP!

TENSION READOUT
 $\times 10^3 \text{ N/m}^2$



EVERYONE
BACK! NOW!

NO... THERE
MIGHT BE A
WINDOW...

IF I CAN
PINPOINT THE
PHASE SHIFT...

RISK: EXTREME.

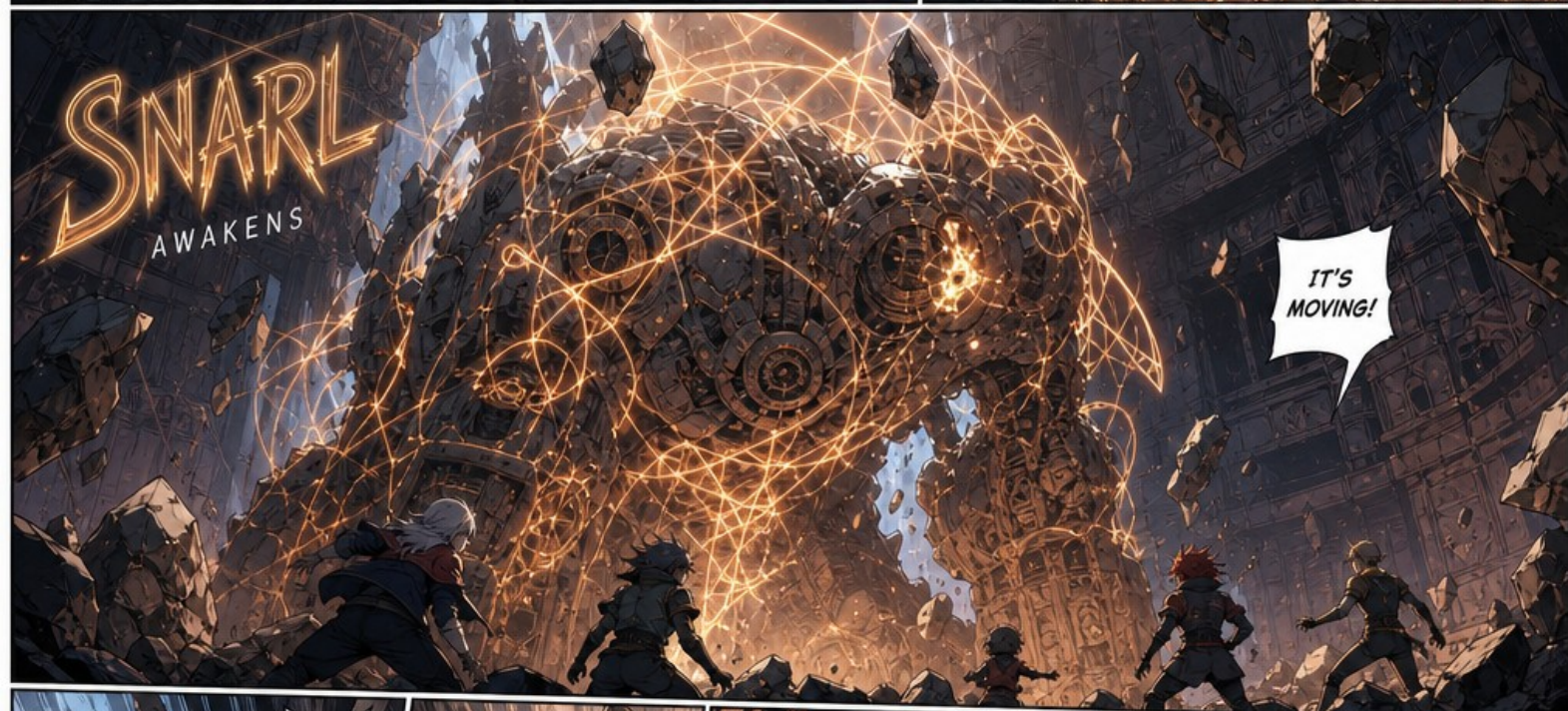
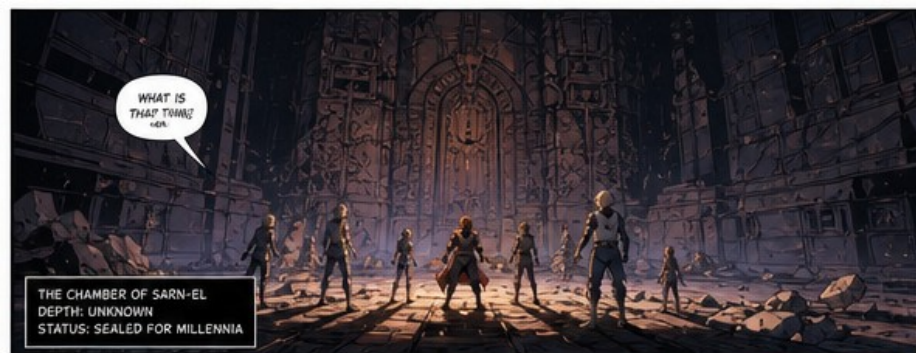
BUT IF I CAN
MODULATE THE
COUNTER-FREQUENCY
AT THE NODAL
INTERSECTION...

...THERE'S A
0.7% CHANCE
WE CAN STABILIZE
THE SYSTEM.

BIX!

DON'T YOU
DARE.

WE'LL BUY
YOU THE
TIME.





BIX
TENSION-ENGINEER

R-RENN, VECTOR
SHIFT! 3-2-7!
VERTICAL DROP
INCOMING!

ANGLE'S
NARROW—TWO
HEARTBEATS
MAX!

GOT IT, BIX!
KEEP 'EM
TALKING!

RENN
TENSION-RUNNER



THE SNARL
ANCHORED BEAST
OF THE ABYSSAL HELIX



SLOANE
ANCHORITE VANGUARD
REMAINS

NOW.



TENSION-LINES
HOLDING!

BUT SHE'S
FIGHTING
BACK HARD!



CHAMBER
RESONANCE
SPIKING!

YOU'VE GOT
ONE SHOT!



ALMOST
THERE...

THAT'S THE
ANCHOR-KNOT!

JUST A LITTLE
FARTHER—!



THE SNARL'S
CORE.

THE ANCHOR-KNOT.

IF I CAN UNWEAVE
THIS... EVERYTHING
UNRAVELS.

C'MON,
OLD KNOT...

LET'S SEE WHAT
YOU'RE REALLY
MADE OF.

GRRRRRAA
AAAAHHH!

TENSION-GAUNTLET:
SPOOL ENGAGED.

UNWEAVING.
THREAD BY THREAD.

ONE LOOP.
LOOSENEED.

KRAK!

ANOTHER.
RELEASED.

SHRIIIIEEK!

ANOTHER.
GONE.

FWSSSSHH

THE SNARL'S
TENSION...
DISSIPATING.

FWOOM

IT'S
WORKING.

IT'S
REALLY
WORKING.

THE SNARL IS
UNDONE.

THE CHAMBER
IS QUIET.

THE WEIGHT...
IS GONE.

I'M
STILL HERE.

I DID IT.

THE ANCHOR
IS SILENT...

...BUT NOT
DEAD.

BIX'S INSTRUMENT
HUMS AS IT DRAWS
ON WHAT LITTLE
REMAINS.

LET'S SEE
WHAT YOU'RE
HIDING.

NORTHWEFT
REACHES

THE UNRAVELING

WEFTFALL
BASIN

THE
HEARTWEFT

ECHO
STRANDS

SHEARED
BOUNDARIES

SOUTHWEST
FRAY

IT'S WORSE
THAN WE
IMAGINED.

THE WEFT-LINES
ARE FRACTURING
ACROSS THE
ENTIRE TANGLE.

NOT JUST
RAVELING—

—UNRAVELING.

THE TANGLE
HOLDS BY THREADS
SO THIN THEY
SHOULDN'T EXIST.

ONE WRONG
PULL... AND
EVERYTHING
COMES APART.

NORTHWEFT
REACHES

THE UNRAVELING

WEFTFALL
BASIN

THE
HEARTWEFT

ECHO
STRANDS

SHEARED
BOUNDARIES

SOUTHWEST
FRAY

THERE'S NO
SIMPLE FIX.

ONLY CHOICES.

AND NONE
OF THEM ARE
GOOD ONES.

SO...

WHAT
NOW?

WE
CHOOSE.

THEN WE
ANCHOR.

END OF EPISODE

